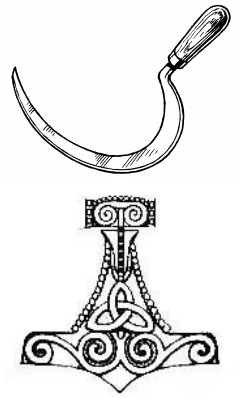


DER BERCHTASLAAF

31. YUULING, 2015



ROBERT LUSCH (MIT DENKI ZUM BRIAN WEIS)
REV - D 7

Honoring: Berchta

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune intoned thrice: Perthro, Laguz, Kenaz, Dagaz

Die Heiliching - The Hallowing

*Hammer un Sichel, heilicht daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe,
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Frey un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
Bei Fraa Holle un Fraa Berchta un fer es Volk zu erneire
Wie schmített der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Hammer un Sichel, heilicht daer Aldaar un die Schtell*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer die Haerrin Berchta zu ehre.

Heel zu de Ziewe!

Heel zu de Wichde!

Heel zum Land!

Heel zu der Gmeeschaft!

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Invocations to Berchta will be made both in Deutsch and in English.

Es Opfer un Die Eed - The Offering and the Oaths

*Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle
Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz voraa.*

*If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.
If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.*

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - The Hallowing of the Offerings

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

<i>Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns</i>	<i>From the gods to the Earth to us</i>
<i>Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder</i>	<i>From us to the Earth to the gods</i>

<i>'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk</i>	<i>A gift for a gift.</i>
<i>Heele!</i>	<i>Hail!</i>

Zum Schluss - In Closing

Zu de Wichde - To the Wights

At Midnight: Crack the whip (representing that of Holle or Berchta), bang pots, shoot air guns, etc., to drive away negativity.

Topics for Discussion

Goddess most likely of the *Wane*. She is seen either as a sister to Holle or as Holle by another name. Her holiday is 31. Yuuling (December) on the current calendar. As is the case with many Teutonic goddesses, She is known for spinning. In the post-Heathen era, Her honor has been tainted by the Church, though the horrid masks that appear as depictions of the Wild Hunt in parts of Germany and Switzerland carry both a fear and a respect for the powerful goddess.

She seeks order in our lives, particularly lucidity of thought. This is, perhaps, akin to this time of introspection and the forming of New Year's Resolutions.

She has a definite "dark" angle to Her, but buried within this aspect is a reflection of the dark side within each of us. We observed, recognized, and even embraced these aspects of ourselves during the time of Belsnickel and Krampus prior to Yule. There is also value in assessing this side of us now we work on improving ourselves in the coming year.

The Berchtaslaaf, or the Progression of Berchta is a feast that includes gruel and fish, which is Berchta's prescribed meal. Urglaawer typically make the fare to consist of herring and oatmeal or dumpling and herring meal (Grimm, *Teutonic* 273). Some folks, particularly our Frankish brethren in Canada, also make Zemmede (also known as Zemmete, Semmede, and a few other variations) as part of Berchta's meal. Zemmede turn up in a number of practices among the Deitsch, too, and we include them in our Twelfth Night observances.

The owl is sacred to Berchta and is known for its wisdom. Historically, among the Christian Deitsch, there was a malediction towards the depiction of owls in drawing or in print, and they were often associated with witches (a connection to Berchta) and cast in a negative light. In the continuing paranoia of witches, owl carcasses were also nailed to the sides of sheds or barns in an attempt to frighten off other owls or to protect against evil spirits. Practitioners of Braucherei, however, never bought into this taboo against this "heathen" practice.